

Test Cost Framework Guide

Synthetic example explaining the planning cost model used in LabOS v0.3.0.

Purpose

The LabOS demo cost model is a transparent planning framework. It is intended to support make/buy, prioritisation, budget forecasting and programme trade-offs; it is not a financial-ledger posting system.

Cost model

Component	Planning basis	Example
Labour	Attended setup, execution, teardown and analysis hours x qualified staff charge rate	6 h x EUR 95/h
Equipment	Occupied test duration x equipment charge rate	96 h x EUR 32/h
Consumables	Method fixed cost + per-DUT variable cost	EUR 80 + 12 x EUR 9
External	Subcontract, freight, specialist analysis or external services	EUR 650
Development	Engineering + technician effort + fixture + external development	40 h eng + fixture
Overhead	Configured percentage applied to direct cost	12%
Contingency	Planning risk percentage applied to pre-contingency cost	8%

Programme control

Measure	Definition
Estimate	Standard resource model for all planned legs
Actual to date	Cost calculated from completed test-run evidence where available
Estimate to complete	Remaining uncompleted legs using current plan/rates
Forecast at completion	Actual to date + estimate to complete
Variance	Forecast at completion - approved programme budget

Recommended governance

Use a reviewed rate card, make development cost explicit, separate direct and overhead assumptions, retain change reasons, and treat large cost variance as a management trigger rather than silently changing the baseline.